

persistent data storage space, where some critical data can be saved and remains persistent.

Try Linux using a virtual machine

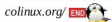
All the methods discussed till now provide a way to experience Linux, but if you really want to use Linux on Windows what you need is an environment which is persistent, more robust and gives you greater freedom to do more than just running Linux. Installing a Linux operating system as a virtual machine (VM) is the answer to this. VMs allow you to have multiple full-fledged Linux distros running on top of Windows, simultaneously. The only limitation to the number of Linux distros is your system's hardware resources. More importantly, all Linux operating systems will be completely isolated from the host Windows system—and from each other as well.

There are various ways to create VMs in Windows but the most common and free open source tool is VirtualBox. You can just download it and use it to create as many virtual machines as you want, to experience running multiple Linux distros simultaneously.

Try coLinux based distributions

Another way to run Linux on Windows is to use coLinux distributions. coLinux or Cooperative Linux is a very new way of running Linux on Windows natively, without any extra partition. Conceptually, coLinux is a port of the Linux kernel that allows it to run cooperatively alongside other OSs. With this, you will not require any virtualisation software to run Linux on Windows. Currently, it only allows the KNOPPIX Japanese version on Windows. But this is a project which is hot and offers a host of development opportunities to all open source enthusiasts.

More details on coLinux can be found at <http://www.colinux.org/>



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